



Mechanical keyboard for Macs

Fed up of using the aesthetic but painful Mac keyboard? Give this chunky and comfy Das Keyboard a try. <https://digit.in/feb19-29>



China unfreezes Tencent

Tencent out of prolonged freeze as Beijing granted licenses to two of its mobile games this month. <https://digit.in/feb19-30>

and luxury in its build and matches that with impeccable audio performance. The only factors that make it fall behind marginally are the lack of an IP rating, a smaller overall battery life, better controls on the Dash Pro and a slightly better fit.

ZEBRONICS ZEB PEACE

Build and design: The Zeb Peace comes with one of the smallest cases that we've seen on True Wireless earbuds. The earbuds themselves are pretty small and lightweight. The outer shell of each earbud has a glossy finish while there's a matte finish on the button and inside. The LEDs to indicate power status and connectivity



Bragi The Dash Pro

ity are quite small and easy to miss. While the buds are described as splash proof, there's no official IP rating on them. These earbuds can individually be paired with smartphones as well, however, only the left one has a mic and can be used for calls. There are no volume controls onboard.

Performance: The audio performance of the Zeb Peace is pretty lacklustre. The lows lack emphasis, resulting in the bass getting quite boomy. The highs sound shrill and cause fatigue over longer periods. While the mids are okay, the shrill highs makes them unsuitable for watching movies or TV shows. Overall, the Zeb Peace offers just enough to justify its pricing, but isn't really an option is you value sound quality.

Verdict: Hitting the lower limits of pricing when it comes to True Wireless earbuds is perhaps the only factor that stands in favour of the Zeb

Peace. The build, while being comfortable and lightweight, is not rugged or dependable. The poor sound quality makes these unsuitable for extended listening. However, this is the best it can get if you're adamant on buying true wireless earbuds and cannot spend more than ₹5000.

BOULT AUDIO TRU5IVE

Build and design: The Boulton Audio Tru5ive is also designed for the athletically inclined, with prominent ear loops extending out of the earbuds. You even get colour options in these, but the loops are pretty flimsy and prone to damage. The power button on the outside is stiff and can be painful to use. These buds pair individually, with the left one as the master. The design could be the strongest point for the buds. The same cannot be said for the case which is quite bulky. The buds, sans the loops, are quite well built and come with an IPX7 rating, so feel free to swim with these.

Performance: At the price point, it is

unfair to expect audio quality that will match devices that cost 3-4 times more. The sound signature of the Tru5ive is fun and lively if anything. IT has a bias towards the lows, with the bass overpowering the mids and the highs on many occasions. There can be a significant amount of sibilance in the highs that can make longer listening sessions a bit difficult.

Verdict: The Tru5ive is intended to be an affordable sports earbud and it fulfils that role quite well. However, since this test squares it up against every earbud on the list with the same criteria, it falls significantly short of being worth a mention on performance and build quality. However, with that being said, there's not too many earbuds at this price point that can boast of Bluetooth 5.0 connectivity and a total battery life above 15 hours. Get this one if you're on a tight budget or want to experiment with the category.

CONCLUSION

WINNER & EDITOR'S PICK

Bragi The Dash Pro

When we conducted the tests for last year's Zero1 Awards for the True Wireless category, The Dash Pro from Bragi fell short of the pole position due to its slight shortcomings as compared to the performance of the Beoplay E8. However, in this test, with all of its features and build quality thrown into the mix, it emerges the winner even if it's by a small margin. It's true that this is the most expensive device on the list at ₹29,999 in India, however, this is a pair of true wireless earbuds that fulfils a ton of purposes without losing out on audio quality. Even after a significant amount of time had passed since we started using it, we found ourselves discovering new features. If you can bear with the complex initial setup, Bragi's The Dash Pro offers a lot for that price.

BEST-BUY

Plantronics Backbeat FIT 3100

While it does fall short of the Bose SoundSport Free in terms of sheer performance, it more than makes up



Plantronics Backbeat FIT 3100

for it when it comes to the build and features. Its IPX7 rating makes it swim friendly compared to the sweatproof IPX4 from Bose. On top of that, the Backbeat FIT 3100 features better controls, doesn't protrude from your ears like an alien pod and is about ₹6000 cheaper than the SoundSport Free, which gets it the Best Buy tag. **d**